

S&P Global Flash Germany PMI®

Growth in German private sector output accelerates in September despite increased inflationary pressures

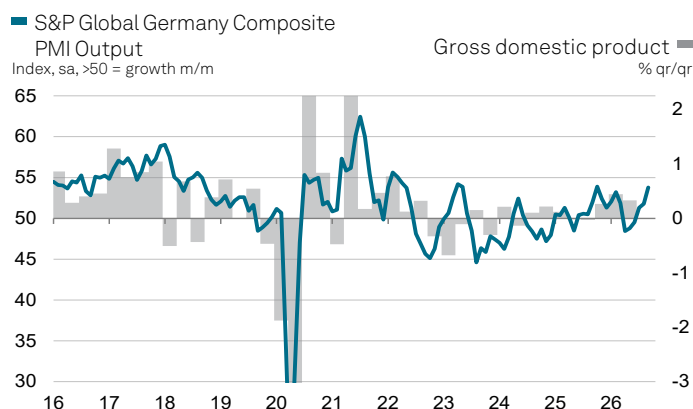
September 2026

Flash Germany PMI Composite Output Index: 53.8 (Aug: 51.8). 11-month high.

Flash Germany Services PMI Business Activity Index: 52.9 (Aug: 49.7). 7-month high.

Flash Germany Manufacturing Output Index: 55.9 (Aug: 56.6). 2-month low.

Flash Germany Manufacturing PMI: 53.8 (Aug: 54.3). 2-month low.



Data were collected 10-21 September 2026.

Sources: S&P Global PMI, Destatis via S&P Global Market Intelligence. © 2026 S&P Global

Businesses in Germany recorded a solid and accelerated increase in output of goods and services at the end of the third quarter, according to the latest PMI® survey data. This was despite firms facing increased inflationary pressures, which they linked in large part to the rising price of fuel. Employment meanwhile rose for the second month in a row as a sustained build-up of backlogs of work pointed to growing pressure on business capacity across the private sector.

The S&P Global Flash Germany Composite PMI Output Index came in at 53.8 in September, up from 51.8 in August and its highest reading since October last year. The rise in the index reflected a renewed increase in business activity across the service sector (index at 52.9), which was the strongest seen since February and ended a five-month sequence of contraction. Manufacturers meanwhile recorded further solid growth in production levels (index at 55.9), albeit with the pace of expansion ticking down slightly from August's 55-month high.

The upturn in business activity was underpinned by rising demand for goods and services. Inflows of new work increased for the third month running in September and to the greatest extent since February 2022. An accelerated expansion in service sector new business – the quickest seen for almost a year – coincided with another robust increase in factory new orders, with firms in both sectors noting the influence of greater investment spending. Another broad-based increase in new export business contributed to the overall rise in new orders.

September saw a second consecutive monthly increase in outstanding business (i.e. orders or projects awaiting completion) across both the manufacturing and service

Comment

Phil Smith, Economics Associate Director at S&P Global Market Intelligence:

"German businesses reported further signs of resilience in September, with output growth picking up speed, expectations towards the outlook holding steady and employment rising for a second month running, all despite renewed pressure on the inflation front.

"The flash data pointed to the strongest rise in business activity for almost a year, with the service sector finally rejoining manufacturing in growth territory after a quieter period that followed the outbreak of the Middle East war.

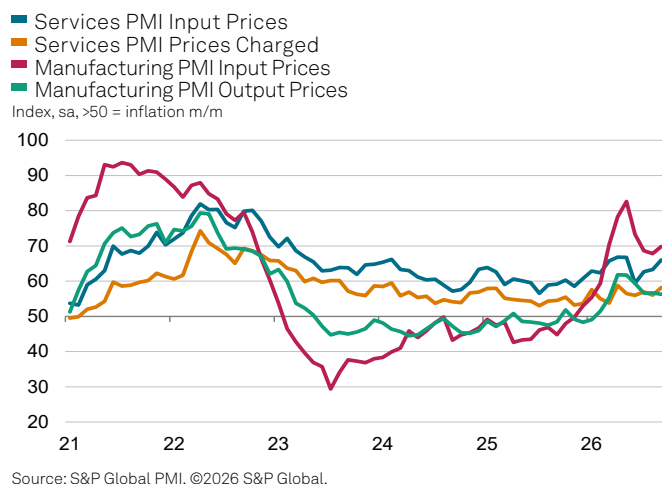
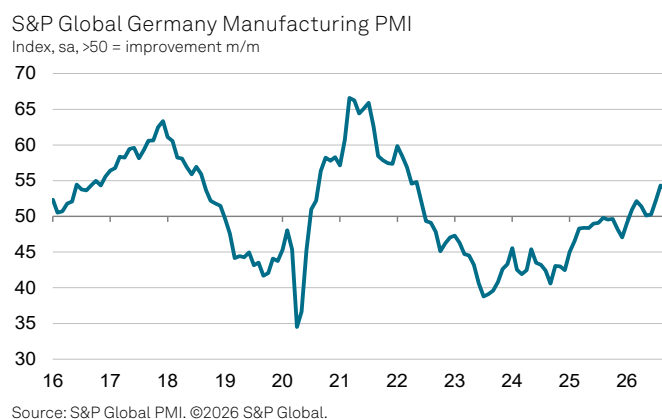
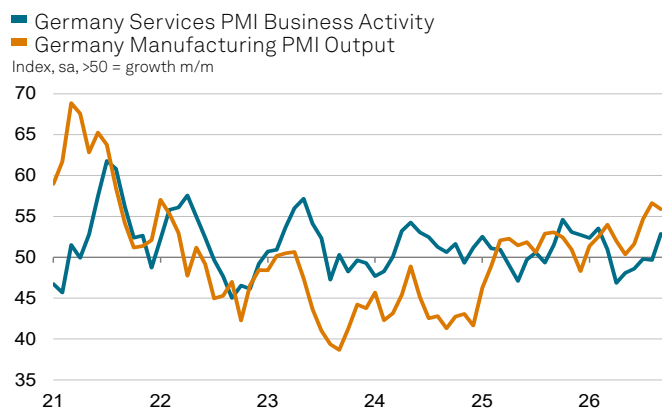
"Rising inflows of new work were starting to put pressure on business capacity, however, as underlined by the accumulation of backlogged orders, which in turn helped strengthen labour market conditions. So far, recent job creation has been confined to the service sector, but factory employment continued to show signs of stabilising as goods producers reported rising levels of work-in-hand and greater optimism towards future output."

sectors. Moreover, the overall pace of accumulation was the quickest recorded since May 2022. This evidence of growing pressure on business capacity was reflected in a second straight monthly increase in workforce numbers across the private sector in September. Although still only modest, the pace of job creation ticked up slightly to the quickest for more than three years, led by another round of hiring across the service sector. Manufacturing payroll numbers meanwhile moved closer to stabilisation, recording their slowest decline since September 2023.

Turning to prices, September's flash results indicated a revival in inflationary pressures across the private sector. Input costs rose at the quickest rate for four months and one that was well above the long-run series average, with surveyed firms widely noting the impact of increased fuel prices and the cost of energy more generally.

Average charges for goods and services likewise rose at the quickest rate since May at the end of the third quarter. The uptick in the rate of inflation owed to stronger price increases among services firms, masking the slowest rise in factory gate charges for six months.

Looking ahead, businesses remained optimistic about growth prospects over the next 12 months. The degree of confidence was unchanged from that seen in August, remaining at its highest level since immediately before the outbreak of the Middle East war in February and just above the long-run average. A further improvement in expectations among manufacturers offset a slip dip in sentiment across the service sector.



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Methodology

Final September data are published on 1 October for manufacturing and 5 October for services and composite indicators.

The S&P Global Flash Germany Composite PMI® is compiled by S&P Global from responses to questionnaires sent to survey panels of around 400 manufacturers and 400 service providers. The panels are each stratified by detailed sector and company workforce size, based on contributions to GDP. The services sector is defined as consumer (excluding retail), transport, information, communication, finance, insurance, real estate and business services.

Survey responses are collected in the second half of each month and indicate the direction of change compared to the previous month. The following variables are monitored:

Manufacturing: Output, new orders, new export orders, backlogs of work, stocks of finished goods, employment, quantity of purchases, suppliers' delivery times, stocks of purchases, input prices, output prices, future output.

Services: Business activity, new business, new export business, outstanding business, employment, input prices, prices charged, future activity.

A diffusion index is calculated for each manufacturing and services variable. The index is the sum of the percentage of 'higher' responses and half the percentage of 'unchanged' responses. The indices vary between 0 and 100, with a reading above 50 indicating an overall increase compared to the previous month, and below 50 an overall decrease. The indices are then seasonally adjusted.

Composite indices for are calculated by weighting together comparable manufacturing and services indices using official manufacturing and services annual value added.

The headline figure is the Composite Output Index. This is a weighted average of the Manufacturing Output Index and the Services Business Activity Index. It may be referred to as the 'Composite PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI, which is a weighted average of five manufacturing indices (including the Manufacturing Output Index).

The headline manufacturing figure is the Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index™ (PMI®). The PMI is a weighted average of the following five indices: New Orders (30%), Output (25%), Employment (20%), Suppliers' Delivery Times (15%) and Stocks of Purchases (10%). For the PMI calculation the Suppliers' Delivery Times Index is inverted so that it moves in a comparable direction to the other indices.

The headline services figure is the Services Business Activity Index. This is a diffusion index calculated from a single question that asks for changes in the volume of business activity compared with one month previously. The Business Activity Index is comparable to the Manufacturing Output Index. It may be referred to as the 'Services PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI.

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Flash data are calculated from around 80-90% of total responses and are intended to provide an accurate early indication of the final data. Since flash data were first processed, the average differences between final and flash index values for the headline indices are:

Composite Output Index = 0.0 (absolute difference 0.4)

Services Business Activity Index = -0.1 (absolute difference 0.6)

Manufacturing PMI = 0.0 (absolute difference 0.3)

S&P Global do not revise underlying survey data after first publication, but seasonal adjustment factors may be revised from time to time as appropriate which will affect the seasonally adjusted data series. Historical data relating to the underlying (unadjusted) numbers, first published seasonally adjusted series and subsequently revised data are available to subscribers from S&P Global.

For further information on the PMI survey methodology, please contact economics@spglobal.com.

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